

SKOAR!

ASURA'S WRATH

God of War in Asia

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We didn't quite know what to expect when we started reviewing Asura's Wrath. It had been in the news for all the right reasons, the videos looked mind-blowing and the story vaguely similar to a famous PS3 title. The game has been both an epiphany and a huge letdown, an epiphany as far as story-telling in games go, but a letdown in gameplay.

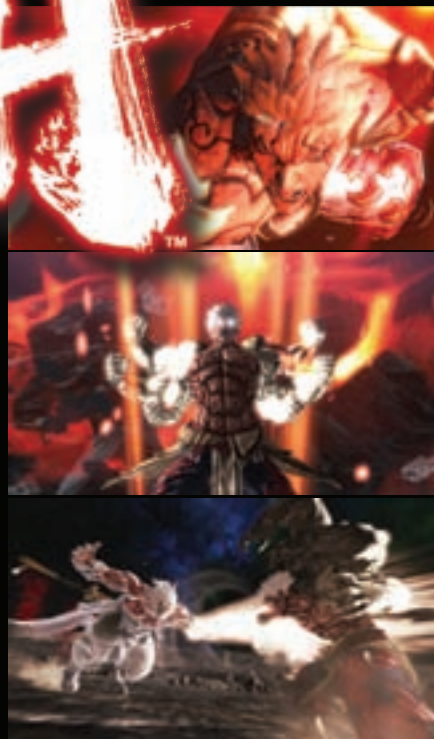
We won't delve much into the plot as it seems merely in place to facilitate the violence. The story is about an internal power struggle among the generals of the gods who stay in a giant Buddha-shaped spaceship (we kid you not). Asura's wife is killed and his daughter is kidnapped by the other generals, the rest of the game is about how he attains revenge.

The visuals are splendid, the graphic artists have done a great job in capturing the mythological, sci-fi world. The game plays out as an anime and is divided into 18 chapters, each chapter lasting about 20 minutes. Each of the chapter has its own opening and closing sequences with incredibly detailed bumpers, along with a short manga-style narrative

which gives you a little more insight into the minds of the characters.

Most of the game unfolds as self-indulgent cut scenes and you're merely a spectator. Combat is over-the-top, gratuitous and entertaining. It's the usual button-mashing fest with a string of QTEs thrown in to keep things a bit lively. Most of the times you're fighting with your bare hands, sometimes with six and sometimes without any (you sort of indulge in some head-butting). Then there's the "burst mode", basically you go on bashing the enemies, performing combos until your burst meter gets full, and irrespective of how many enemies you're fighting, you'll perform a series of moves which will lead to the largest of the enemies (usually a giant fat Buddha or a gargantuan tortoise) biting the dust and the rest of them magically disappearing. The game propels you into the next section of the narrative, as soon as you complete a burst.

The boss fights are the most entertaining, especially the one with a mini-planet sized general called Wyzen and the Dragonball-Z like fight that ensues, finishing off with Asura being skewered at the end of a mile long sword. One thing to point out though, the QTEs function regardless of whether you press the button.*



Verdict

What plagues this game is the incredibly short playing time of 6 hours, and the fact that it has got no real replay value. Who in a sane frame of mind will go through the excruciatingly long cut scenes just for the story? Despite this, it's an excellent attempt to break out from the crop of usual action games, but only recommended if you haven't got anything more interesting at hand.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** CyberConnect2
- » **Publisher:** Capcom
- » **Genre:** Action, Beat em' up
- » **Platforms:** PS3, Xbox360
- » **Price:** ₹3,299 (PS3 & Xbox)

